

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/9: Dualist architecture

SĀṂKHYA = PRE-EXISTENCE OF THE EFFECT IN THE CAUSE (satkāryavāda) + CONSTITUTIVE PRINCIPLE

(tattva) EVOLUTION + PLURAL CONSCIOUS WITNESS (puruṣas)

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PRIMORDIAL MATERIAL NATURE (Prakṛti)

CONSCIOUS WITNESS (puruṣa)

one, unconscious, productive

many, conscious, inactive witnesses

unmanifest nature (avyakta) equilibrium of qualities (guṇas)

uncaused, unchanging,

non-agent

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apparent association explains experience; discrimination ends bondage.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/9: Textual identity, suffering and subtle continuity

TRADITION: Kapila → Āṣṇī → Pāṇasikha; early works not securely extant

CLASSICAL OWNER: Īśvarakṛṣṇa's Sāṃkhyakārikā; later commentarial layers vary

THREEFOLD SUFFERING: ādhyātmika | ādhibhautika | ādhidaivika

SUBTLE BODY: liṅga-śarīra = 18 principles carrying dispositions between bodies

Conscious witness (puruṣa) neither acts nor migrates; empirical subtle body bears action and moral consequence (karma) and rebirth

CLASSICAL POSITION: non-theistic/God-unproved; later Vijñānabhikṣu re-theizes

YOGA BOUNDARY: Yoga owns citta, kleśa, samādhi, eight limbs and special Conscious witness (puruṣa)

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/9: Knowledge and proof of primordial material nature (Prakṛti)

THREE MEANS OF VALID KNOWLEDGE (pramāṇa): perception | inference | reliable testimony

primordial material nature (Prakṛti) is inferred, not ordinarily perceived

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finite effects require cause -> effects share common features

coordinated world requires common source -> evolutes need an unevolved ground

pleasure/pain/dullness in effects -> sattva/rajas/tamas in cause

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PRIMORDIAL MATERIAL NATURE (Prakṛti): beginningless, unmanifest, independent material cause;

not “matter” alone, but psychophysical source of intellect, senses and elements.

proof 3 exact reading: śaktiṭaḥ pravṛtṭeś ca -> operation from causal power

proof 5 avibhāgāt vaiśvarūpyasya -> one undivided material root

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/9: Three qualities (guṇas)

SATTVA

lightness | illumination | pleasure

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PRIMORDIAL MATERIAL NATURE (Prakṛti)

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equilibrium breaks

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RAJAS ----- TAMAS

activity | stimulation | pain inertia | obstruction | dullness

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qualities (guṇas) are constituents, not detachable qualities

mutual domination + support + production drive all manifest difference.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/9: Twenty-five principles (tattvas)

PRIMORDIAL MATERIAL NATURE (Prakṛti) (1)

-> COSMIC INTELLECT (mahat) / DETERMINATIVE INTELLECT (buddhi) (2)

-> EGO-MAKER (ahaṁkāra) (3)

+> sāttvika -> SENSORY MIND (manas) (4) + 5 JÑĀNENDRIYAS + 5 KARMENDRIYAS

+> tāmasa -> 5 SUBTLE ELEMENT (tanmātras) -> 5 GROSS ELEMENT (mahābhūtas)

+> rājasa supplies activity to both branches

CONSCIOUS WITNESS (puruṣa) (25) stands outside the evolute chain as witness

COUNT CONTROL: 1 primordial material nature (Prakṛti) + 23 evolutes + conscious witness (puruṣa)

= 25 principles (tattvas).

11 instruments: hearing/touch/sight/taste/smell + speech/grasping/walking/excretion/reproduction + sensory mind (manas)

5 subtle element (tanmātras): sound | touch | form | taste | smell

5 gross elements: ether | air | fire | water | earth

cause only 1 | cause-effect 7 | effects only 16 | neither 1 Conscious witness (puruṣa)

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/9: Pre-existence of the effect in the cause (satkāryavāda)

EFFECT PRE-EXISTS LATENTLY IN CAUSE

asadakaraṇāt: non-being cannot be produced

upādānagrahaṇāt: specific material cause is selected

sarvasambhavābhāvāt: not everything arises from everything

śaktasya śakyakaraṇāt: cause produces only what it has power to produce

kāraṇabhāvāt: effect shares nature of cause

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real transformation (pariṇāmavāda): real transformation of primordial material nature (Prakṛti)

NYĀYA new production (ārambhavāda): new effect | ADVAITA vivarta: apparent transformation.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/9: Why many conscious witness (puruṣas)?

CONSCIOUS WITNESS (puruṣa) EXISTS BECAUSE

composites serve another | experience needs conscious witness

objects of three qualities (guṇas) require non-guṇa experiencer | liberation is conceivable

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PLURALITY: births/deaths differ; sense capacities and actions are uncoordinated;

if one conscious witness (puruṣa), one person's liberation or pain would belong to all

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CONTACT PROBLEM: inactive consciousness cannot literally touch unconscious primordial material nature (Prakṛti)

analogies: blind-and-lame cooperation | magnet and iron

pressure remains: how does mere proximity begin purposive evolution?

Kārikā 18: fixed births/deaths/faculties | non-simultaneous activity | constituent quality (guṇa) differences

differential liberation = supplementary plurality argument

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/9: Bondage, liberation and critique

AVIVEKA: determinative intellect (buddhi)'s states are appropriated as "I" by reflected

consciousness

experience + karmic dispositions -> repeated embodiment

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tattva-jñāna / viveka-khyāti: "I am conscious witness (puruṣa), not primordial material nature (Prakṛti) or its evolutes"

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primordial material nature (Prakṛti) has been seen -> ceases activity for that conscious witness (puruṣa) -> ISOLATION (kaivalya)

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ŚAMKARA: unconscious primordial material nature (Prakṛti) cannot act for an end; dualism cannot explain contact

SĀMKHYA REPLY: teleology is immanent, as milk flows for calf; no creator is needed.

Conscious witness (puruṣa) is never really bound, liberated or transmigrating

jīvanmukti: knowledge now; body continues like potter's wheel

videhamukti: subtle/gross embodiment finally ceases

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/9: PYQ answer synthesis

START with source-controlled dualism and threefold suffering -> one Primordial material nature

(Prakṛti), many Conscious witness (puruṣas)

- > draw exact 25-tattva cascade -> defend pre-existence of the effect in the cause (satkāryavāda) with five reasons
- > distinguish real transformation (pariṇāmavāda) from ārambha/vivarta
- > explain aviveka and isolation (kaivalya) -> test contact and teleology objections

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QUALIFIED VERDICT: Sāṃkhya powerfully unifies cosmos, mind and liberation,
but the coordination of inactive consciousness with unconscious nature is its hard problem.